

1. Motivation

- The application of compact computational kernels across a mesh (e.g. fig. 1) crops up all the time in continuum mechanics simulations.
- Writing this traversal code by hand quickly becomes difficult due to the need to support different PDEs, discretisations, hardware, etc.
- Therefore, a software abstraction that can automate the construction of the traversal code is needed.

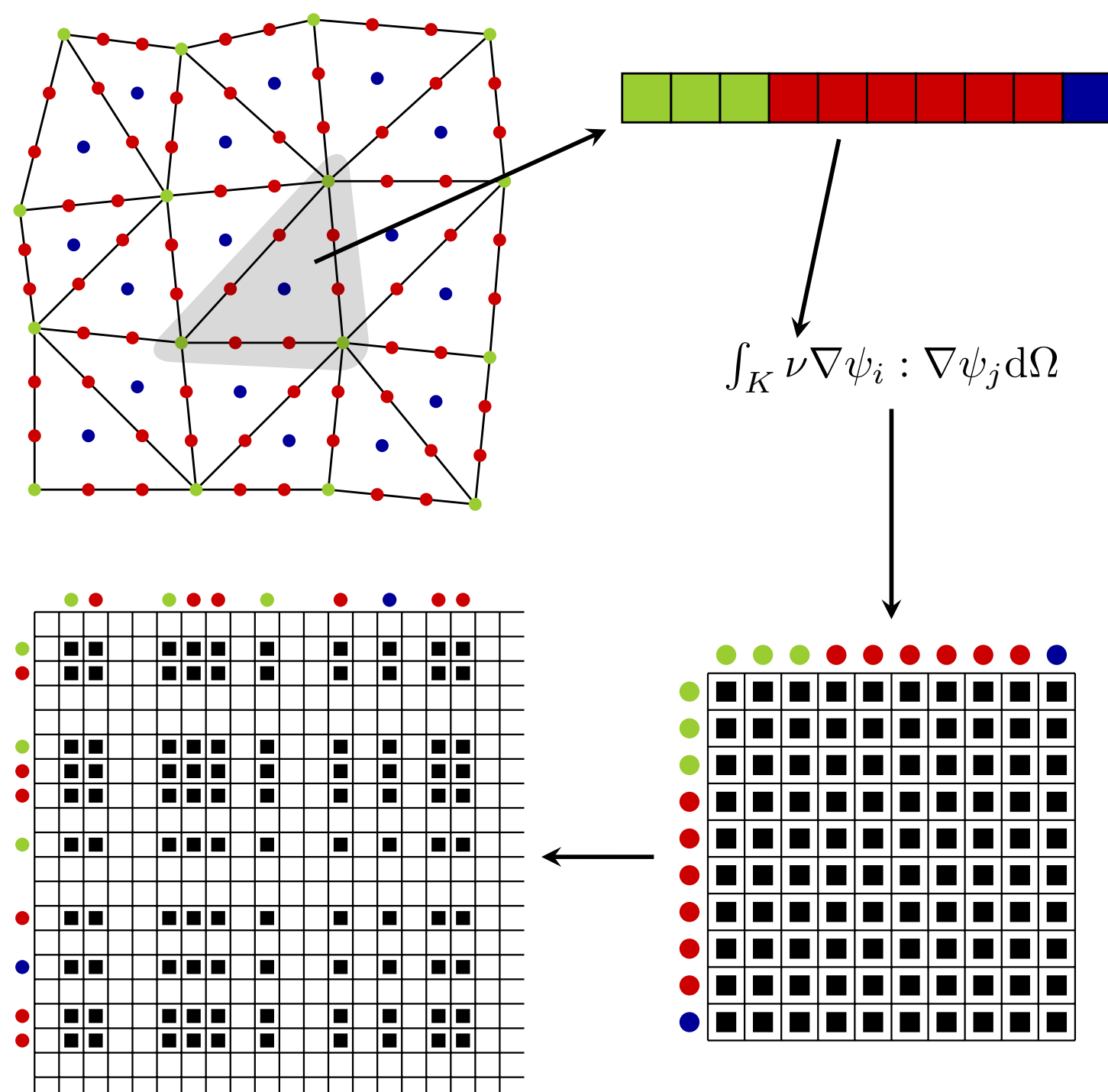


Figure 1: A classic example of applying a compact kernel to a mesh: finite element assembly of a matrix.

2. Introducing pyop3

- pyop3 is a new domain-specific language for automating calculations involving mesh traversal.
- It uses code generation (e.g. fig. 2) to outperform equivalent library interfaces.
- It is based on PyOP2 [2], and work is in progress to replace PyOP2 with pyop3 in the Firedrake finite element framework [1].

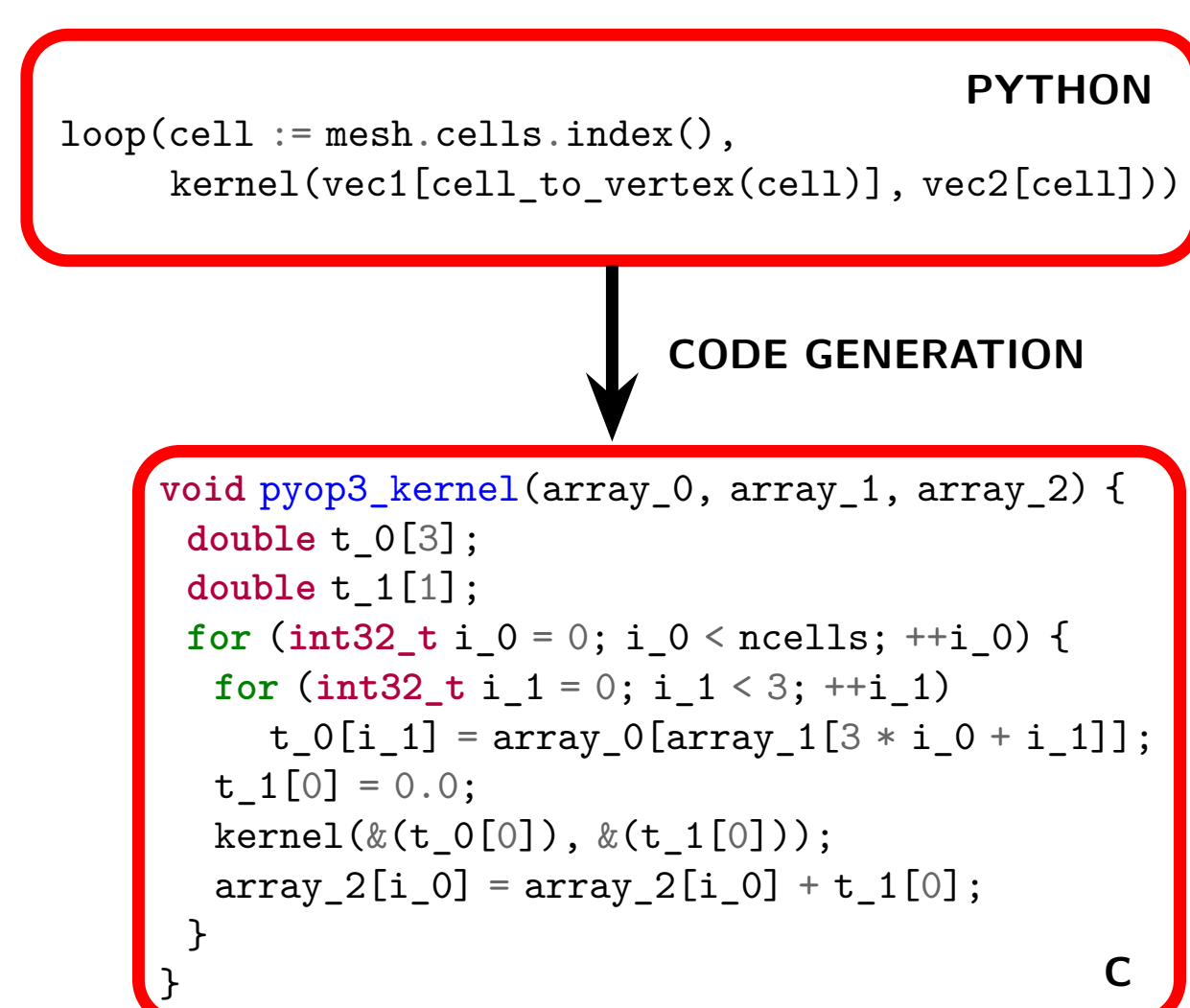


Figure 2: Simplified example of the code generated from a pyop3 loop expression.

References

- [1] David A. Ham, Paul H. J. Kelly, et al. Firedrake User Manual. First edition. manual. 2023.
- [2] Florian Rathgeber, Graham R. Markall, et al. "PyOP2: A High-Level Framework for Performance-Portable Simulations on Unstructured Meshes". In: 2012. (Visited on 04/19/2020).

3. A new abstraction for mesh data

- Mesh data has a complicated structure (fig. 4) that maps poorly to existing ways of describing data layouts (e.g. N-dimensional arrays).
- Unlike PyOP2, pyop3 is capable of fully describing complex mesh data layouts using axis trees (fig. 5).
- Having a richer abstraction for data layouts makes composition easier, and thus pyop3 is able to describe and generate code for a wider range of problems than PyOP2.

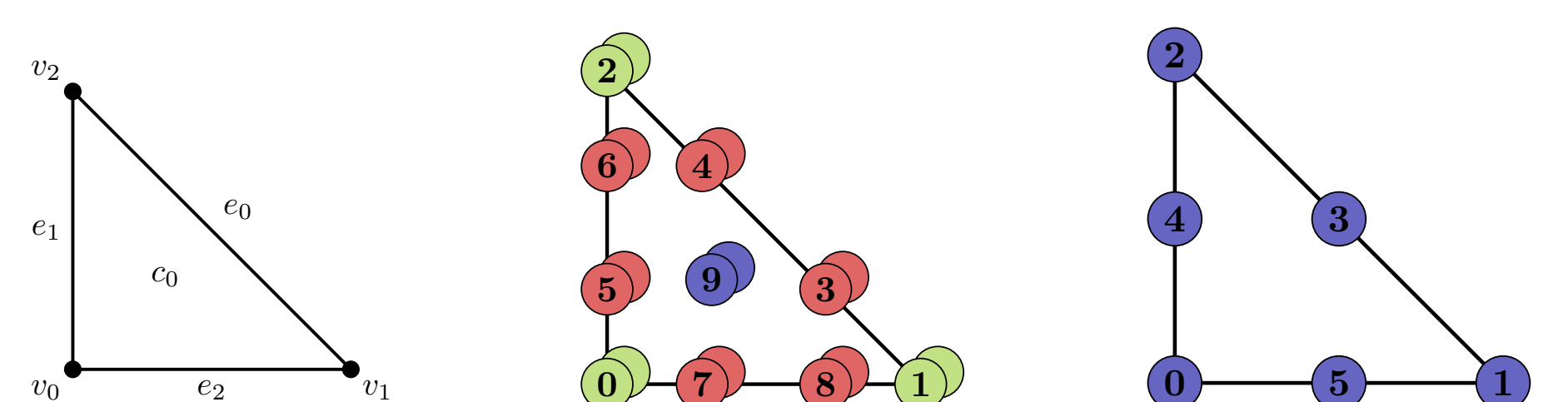


Figure 3: An example of a mixed finite element (Scott-Vogelius, middle and right) on a reference triangle (left). DoFs associated with vertices, edges and cells are shown in green, red and blue respectively. The lower-order element (right) is discontinuous, so all the DoFs are considered to belong to the cell.

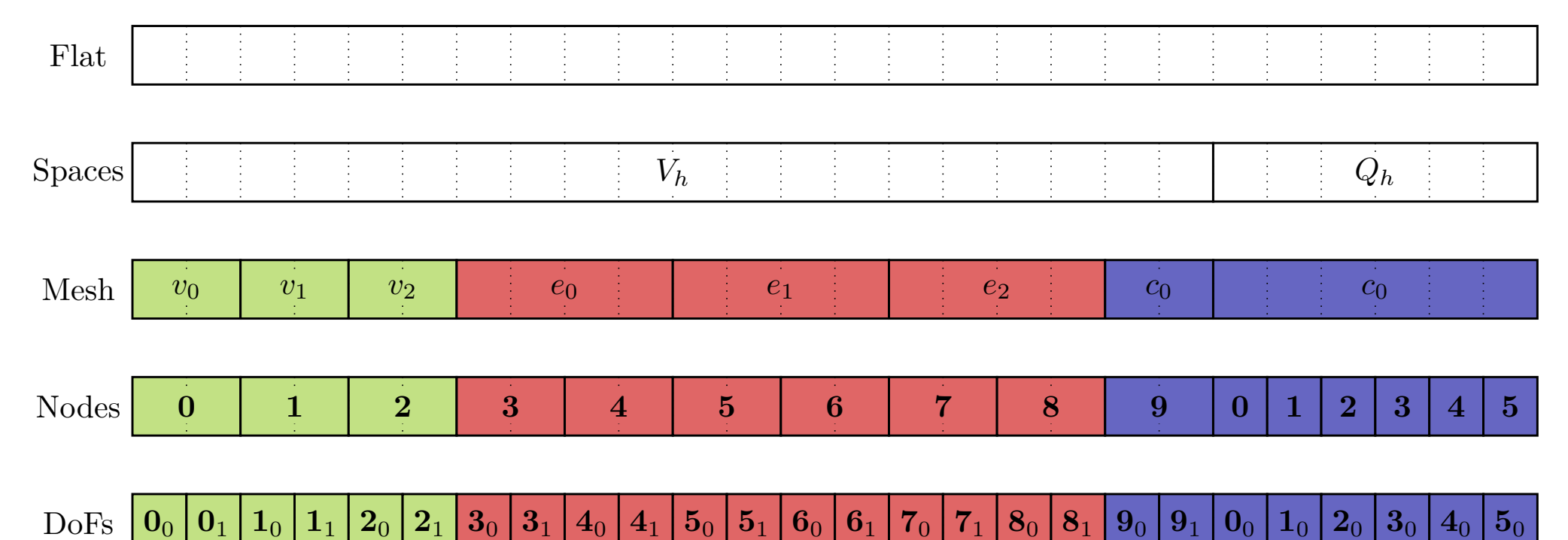


Figure 4: Different views of a possible data layout for a one-cell mesh of the mixed finite element (fig. 3). The labels V_h and Q_h represent the function spaces of the two elements.

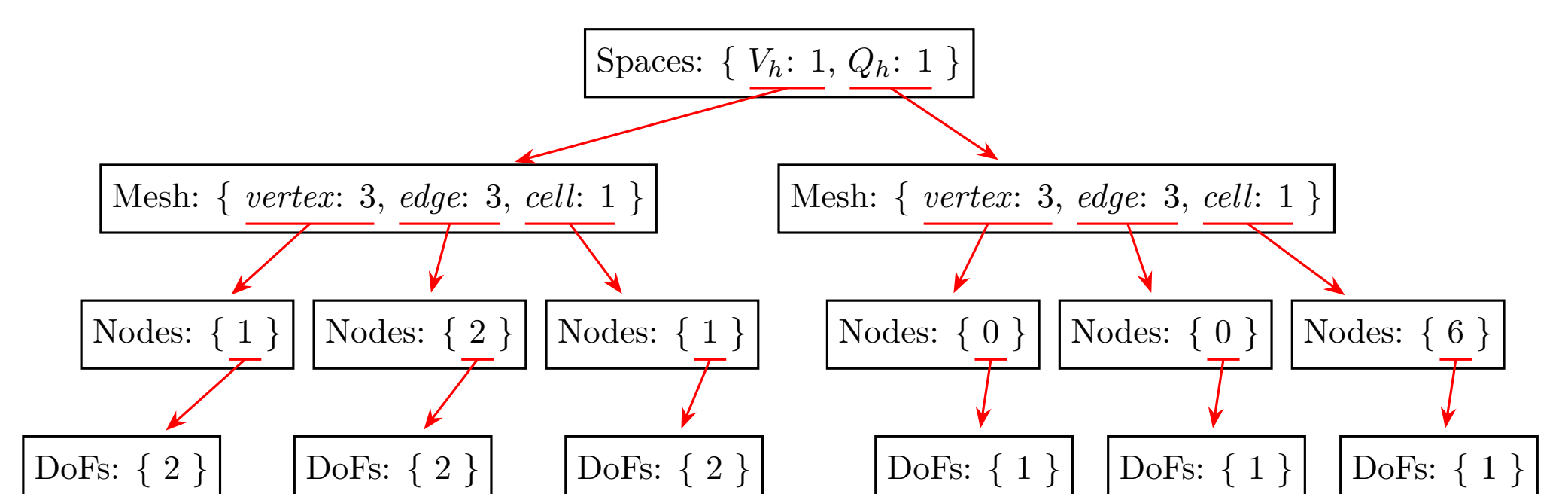


Figure 5: An axis tree that describes the data layout shown in fig. 4.

4. Future work

Once pyop3 has been fully integrated into Firedrake, there is scope for a variety of performance improvements and avenues of research to pursue. Possible low-level changes include:

- GPU support (high priority)
- Data layout transformations
- Loop tiling

Whilst at a high level the following should also become expressible:

- Physics-based preconditioners
- Slope limiters
- Adaptivity
- Particle methods
- And more!

